Jefferson Dual Assignment: Analysis of Current State & Options

The Jefferson Dual Assignment area consists of ten elementary and K8 school attendance areas and two dual language immersion programs.

Elementary School/ Immersion Program	Middle School	High School Dual Assignment
Beach	Ockley Green	Jefferson/Roosevelt
Boise-Eliot/Humboldt	Harriet Tubman	Jefferson/Grant
Chief Joseph	Ockley Green	Jefferson/Roosevelt
Dr. Martin Luther King Jr	Harriet Tubman	Jefferson/Grant
Faubion (North) PK8	Faubion	Jefferson/Roosevelt
Faubion (South) PK8	Faubion	Jefferson/McDaniel
Irvington	Harriet Tubman	Jefferson/Grant
Peninsula	Ockley Green	Jefferson/Roosevelt
Sabin	Harriet Tubman	Jefferson/Grant
Vernon K8	Vernon	Jefferson/McDaniel
Woodlawn	Ockley Green	Jefferson/Roosevelt
Spanish Immersion - Beach	Ockley Green	Roosevelt
Chinese Immersion - Dr. Martin Luther King Jr	Harriet Tubman	Jefferson

Most schools have historic ties to Jefferson, while some elementary schools were added to dual assignment zones as part of K-8 reconfiguration: Peninsula was added in 2016 when it converted from a K-8 to a K-5 feeding to Ockley Green MS, and Irvington and Sabin were added to dual assignment in 2018 when reconfigured into K-5 schools feeding Harriet Tubman MS.

In summer 2025 a multi-disciplinary team began reviewing data and developing high school boundary options. October 2024 enrollment became the baseline for current student information and forecast modeling. Of the 2,384 high schoolers who lived in a Jefferson Dual Assignment zone and attended a PPS school last year, 381 students (15.9%) attended Jefferson. The table below shows the 2024-25 dual assignment zone population by grade level and the type of PPS school the students attend.

HS Students by Jefferson Zone - 2024-25				
Enrolled School	**Jefferson/ Grant**	**Jefferson/ McDaniel**	**Jefferson/ Roosevelt**	**Total**
Jefferson High School	114	63	204	**381**
Comprehensive Option*	699	197	462	**1358**
Benson High School	59	37	127	**223**
Other PPS High Schools**	144	79	199	**422**
Total	**1016**	**376**	**992**	**2384**

*A student's specific comprehensive HS choice based on the home address
**Includes alternatives and other comprehensive high schools

Attached to this memo are maps showing the distribution of the 2024-25 dual assignment population by race and ethnicity and by the type of PPS high school attending. It is notable that nearly 40% of Black students who live in dual assignment zones attended Jefferson High School, while 75% of White students were enrolled in their comprehensive option.

In an effort to understand the unique relationship each feeder school has to Jefferson and other high schools, staff interviewed each school principal in August 2025 and attended back-to-school nights at all campuses. At those events many families were curious and excited about the Jefferson modernization. We also met families who expressed a general belief that, because Jefferson's enrollment is so much smaller than comprehensive high schools, the school cannot offer academic depth and breadth, electives, clubs and sports comparable to comprehensive high schools. During the fall engagement efforts staff shared materials to show that, in fact, Jefferson students have access to more advanced, college-level coursework than students at most PPS comprehensive high schools, thanks to the Middle College program and partnership with Portland Community College (PCC). While enrollment does impact the range of Career and Technical Education (CTE) options and sports teams available, Jefferson students have other unique opportunities, including access to individualized supports through Self-Enhancement, Inc, and the most robust dance program in the district.

Options with Analysis

The primary purpose of this project was to develop alternatives to dual assignment that would align with optimal boundary factors described in PPS 4.10.045-P. Therefore, the project scope was limited to direct impact only on the high schools that participate in dual assignment. Enrollment scenarios are based upon existing elementary school boundaries and Dual Language program feeder patterns, since a subsequent district rightsizing effort will be underway later this school year.

Staff developed five options, Scenarios A-E that reassigned the eight elementary schools and two dual language immersion pathways to Jefferson or another high school. In all of the scenarios students at Faubion PK8 and Vernon K8 would be assigned to Jefferson. The changes were planned to begin with incoming 9th grade students in fall of 2027, adding a new grade each year, as described in PPS 4.10.045-P.

The multi-disciplinary team reviewed each of the scenarios using the PPS Equity Lens, a tool for evaluating decisions to disrupt inequities and advance the district's continuous improvement and equity goals. In the evaluation of each scenario, scenarios A, D and E did not provide students at Jefferson or Roosevelt, schools that serve a high proportion of historically underserved students, access to stable and well-resourced educational opportunities. In addition the team suggested that we look closely at the impact on Roosevelt in particular due to the high proportion of historically underserved students and its relative geographic isolation, while also attending to supporting students who are currently at Jefferson and maintaining the school culture.

The first level of scenario analysis was whether the estimated enrollment at any of the four high schools would be below an enrollment "floor" of 1,100 students in 2030-31, the year the changes will be fully implemented. Enrollment at Roosevelt was expected to be below the threshold in scenarios A and D, while enrollment at Jefferson would likely be lower than 1,100 in scenario E. The remaining scenarios, B and C, satisfied four of five key performance indicators:

- Enrollment at all four schools was estimated to be above 1,100 students in 2030-31
- 100% of Black and Native American students would attend schools with at least 1,100 students
- 100% of Multilingual Learners would attend schools with at least 1,100 students
- The difference in enrollment between the smallest and largest schools would improve to 371 students, close to the 350 student target (the difference in 2024-25 was 1,690 students).

The next level of analysis focused on the degree of students who would move together from middle to high school and proximity. Scenario B kept all Harriet Tubman MS students together at Jefferson, but about a third of the Irvington boundary is within one mile of Grant HS, meaning that more than 100 students within a reasonable walking distance of that school would have to use transportation to attend Jefferson. Additionally, Grant enrollment would decline by more than 800 students between 2024-2030. Alternatively, Scenario C assigned Irvington to Grant, which created a split feeder pattern for Harriet Tubman MS, but preserved enrollment at Grant and kept more students who live within walking distance assigned to their closest high school.

Members of the Irvington and Sabin communities suggested an option in which both Irvington and Sabin would be assigned to Grant HS. Staff analysis showed that this plan would result in estimated enrollment at Jefferson below the threshold of 1,100 students in 2030-31. The enrollment projections were posted on the Jefferson is Rising website. The impacts for Black, Native American and multi-lingual learners would be the same as Scenario E where Jefferson was also projected to be below 1,100 students.